University of BRISTOL
Centre for Academic Language and Development

Foundations of Computer Programming - LANG00052

Week 04

Introduction to Python and IDE

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Learning outcomes

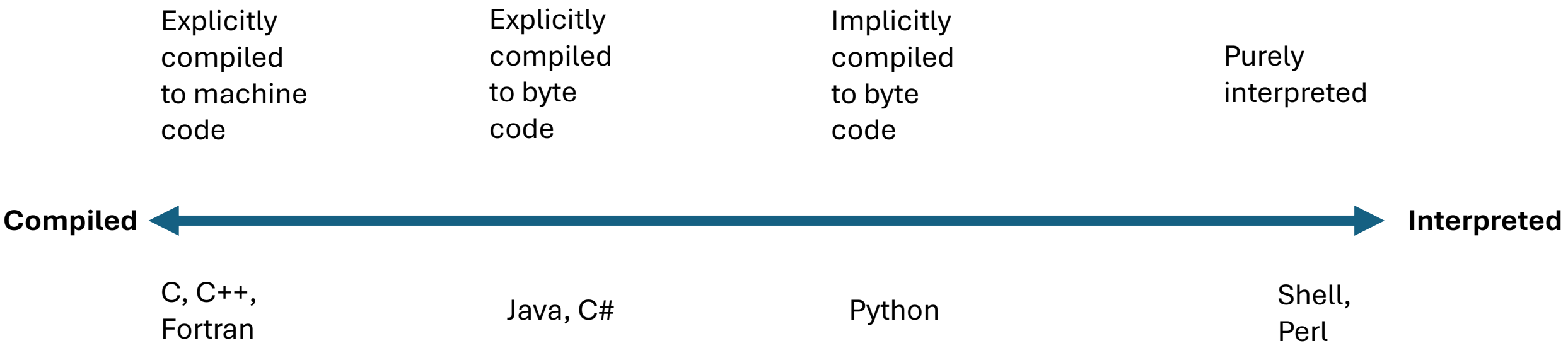
- Installing Python and setting up the Integrated Development Environments
- Understanding Integrated Development Environments and their key features
- Understand the basic difference between compiled and interpreted languages
- Understand the syntax of Python
- Understand the basic use of variables
- Practicing using the IDLE IDE to write, execute, and debug simple Python programs



Python

- Invented in the Netherlands
- Early 90s by Guido van Rossum
- Named after Monty Python
- Open sourced
- Scalable, object oriented and functional
- Used by Google
- Increasingly popular

What sort of language is Python?



Python Releases for Windows

- Latest Python 3 Release - Python 3.12.7

Python Releases for macOS

- Latest Python 3 Release - Python 3.12.7

Running Python

IDE (Integrated Development Environment)

- Editing Source Code
- Syntax Highlighting
- Intelligent code completion
- Compilation
- Testing
- Debugging
- Local Vs. Cloud

Visual Studio Code (VS Code)

Visual Studio Code on macOS

Edit

Installation

1. Download Visual Studio Code for macOS.
2. Open the browser's download list and locate the downloaded app or archive.
3. If archive, extract the archive contents. Use double-click for some browsers or select the 'magnifying glass' icon with Safari.
4. Drag `Visual Studio Code.app` to the **Applications** folder, making it available in the macOS Launchpad.
5. Open VS Code from the **Applications** folder, by double clicking the icon.
6. Add VS Code to your Dock by right-clicking on the icon, located in the Dock, to bring up the context menu and choosing **Options**, **Keep in Dock**.

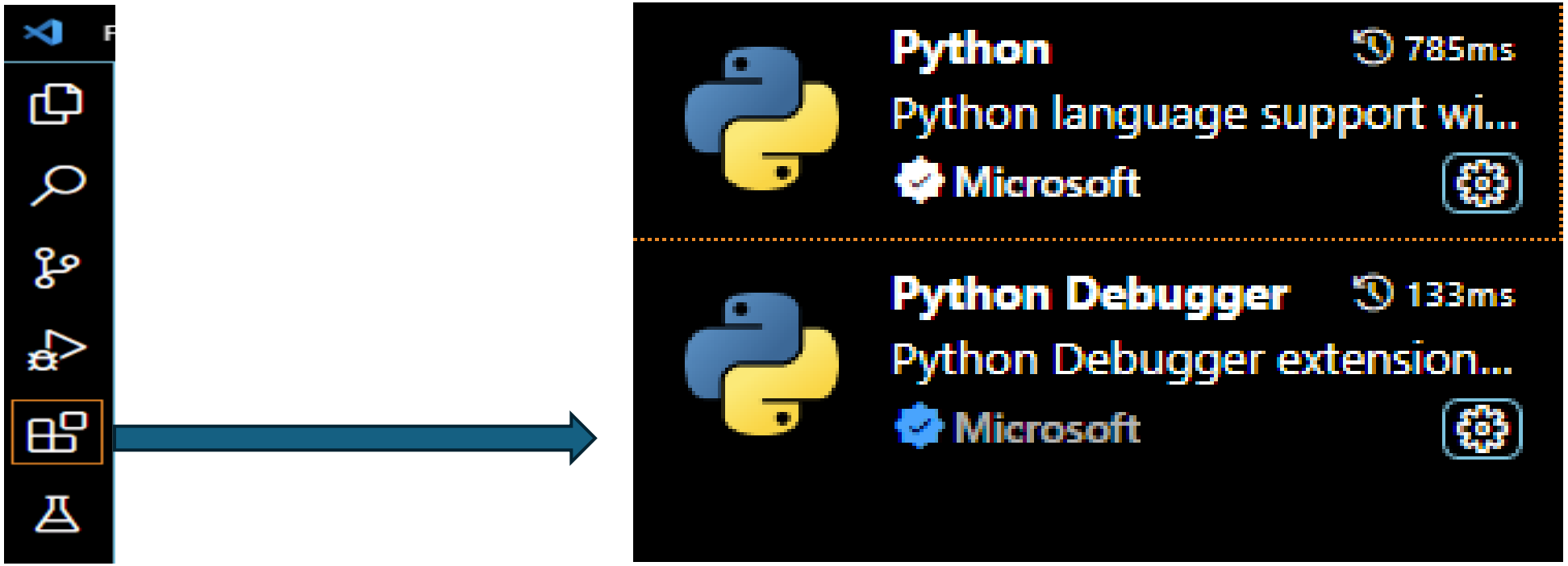
Visual Studio Code on Windows

Edit

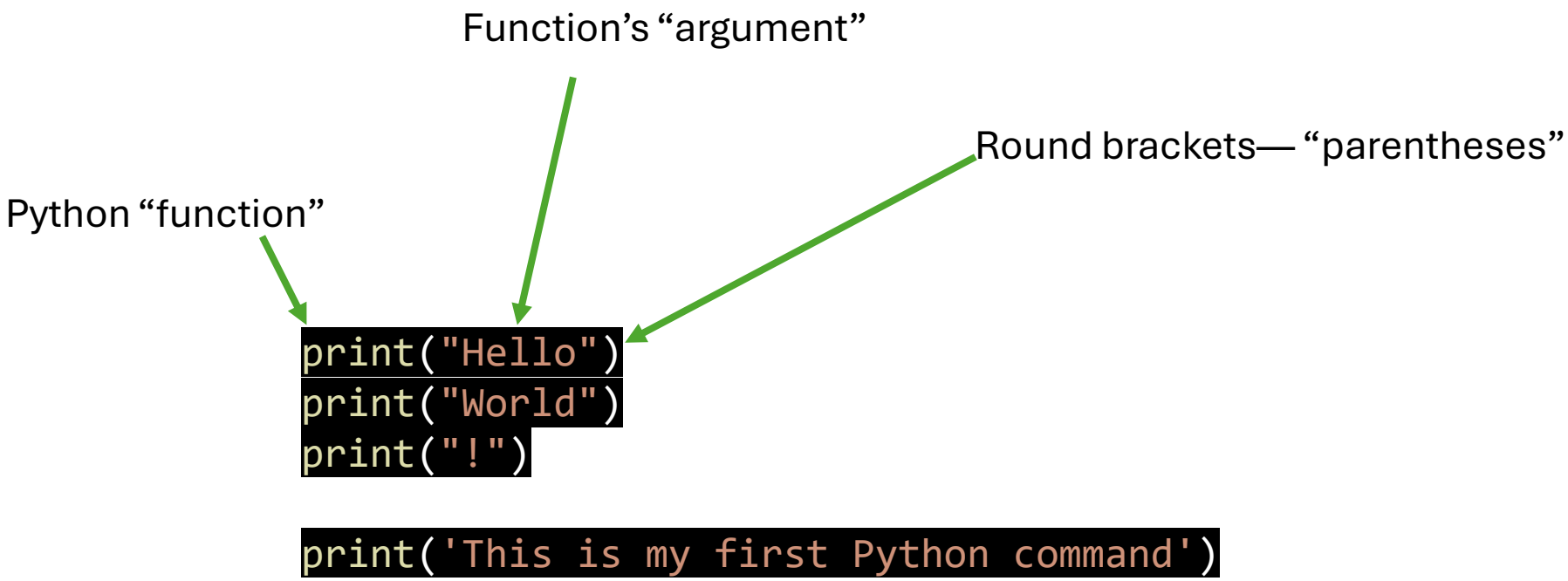
Installation

1. Download the Visual Studio Code installer for Windows.
2. Once it is downloaded, run the installer (VSCodeUserSetup-{version}.exe). This will only take a minute.
3. By default, VS Code is installed under `C:\Users\{Username}\AppData\Local\Programs\Microsoft VS Code`.

VS Code & Python



My first Python command



Python

Case sensitive

Syntax

Double vs Single Quotes

Comments

Module

Time for questions